C Y P H

şifr *(n., arabic)* — zero; the void; the origin of mathematics.

cipher *(n., cryptography)* — a code; a way of encoding meaning.

cypher *(n., music)* — a circle of voices in sequence.

cyph *(n.)* — the new underground for ideas.

founders

jalen daniels

philosopher · technologist · strategist



alma mater
harvard

previous work
ex-mckinsey

startup growth	
institution building	
public intellectual	
inbox 0	
classical ballet	

researching
transhumanism · nietzsche · urban agriculture

bryan cash

computer scientist · sports savant · optimizer



alma mater
syracuse

previous work
ex-washington post

enterprise apps	
design engineering	
big data	
bowling	
chess	

researching
technofeudalism · neuroathletics · molecular gastronomy

advisory board



bakari kitwana
ex-eic of the source magazine

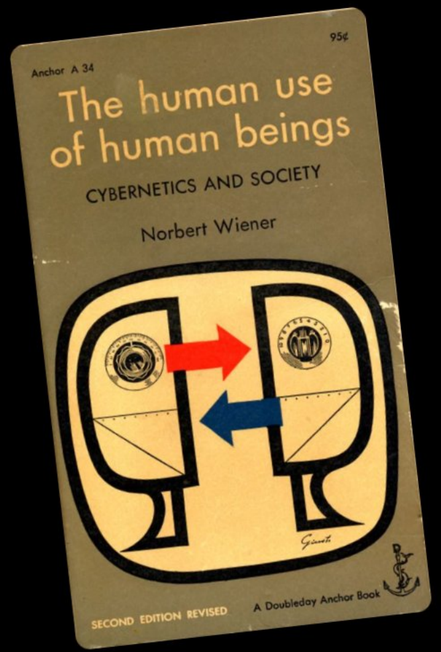


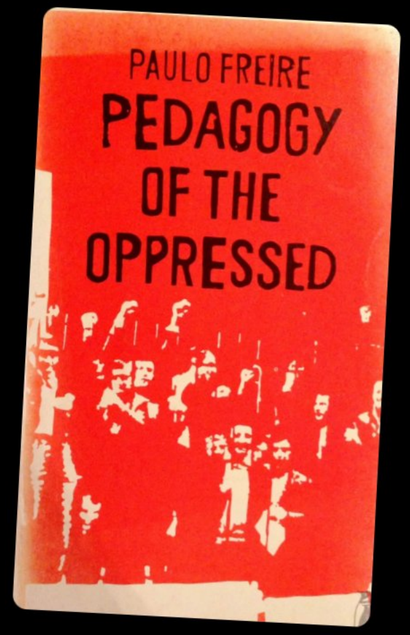
caitlin begg
ceo of authentic social and return to analog podcast

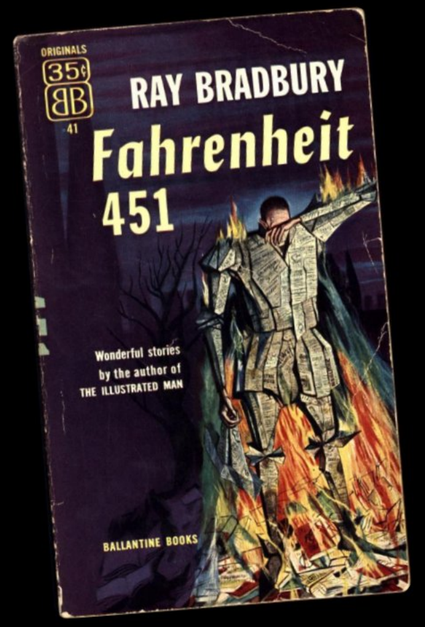


calvary rogers
ex-google, founder of seneca labs

we're in an epistemic crisis.







ai → cognitive resignation

"your brain on chatgpt: accumulation of cognitive debt"

mit media lab

'veritas' is threatened

"college professors say their academic freedom is in decline"

THE CHRONICLE OF HIGHER EDUCATION

monopolized knowledge

"anthropic destroyed millions of rare books to train their models"

wp

but every epistemic crisis always had an underground.



the agora

athens, 500 bc

where free thought had a home before the academy existed.



the salon

paris, 1700s

where conversations that built the enlightenment happened in living rooms.



harlem renaissance

new york, 1920s

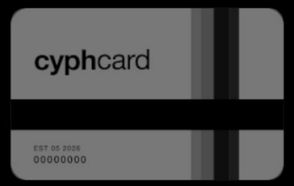
where Black intellectuals made space for possibility in the midst of danger.

cyph is the first underground for human wisdom in the digital age.



see trailer here

user journey





01

underground

where you become intellectually dangerous.

uncover a living world of buried artifacts, rare books, and suppressed ideas — all human made.*







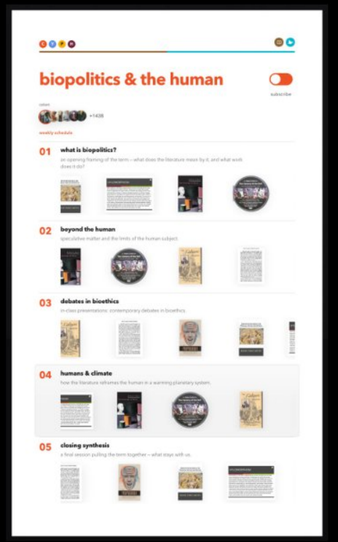
publish or explore routes to intellectual destinations.

the nietzsche route
25 stops

the athlete as activist
21 stops

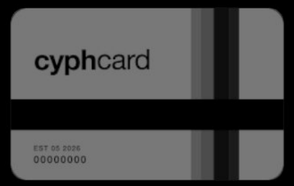
silence as composition
11 stops

teach a cohort learning sesh based on syllabi you design.



*seeded from open source, institutional, and personal collections.

user journey









02

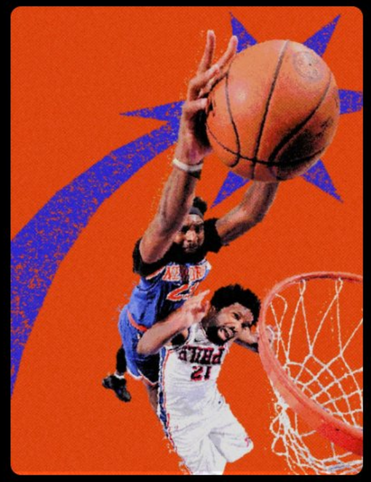
the cyph

where ideas get tested in real time.

spark with thinkers around the world in real time. go deeper in office hours with underground scholars.

live

topics sourced from API's & real-time listening.



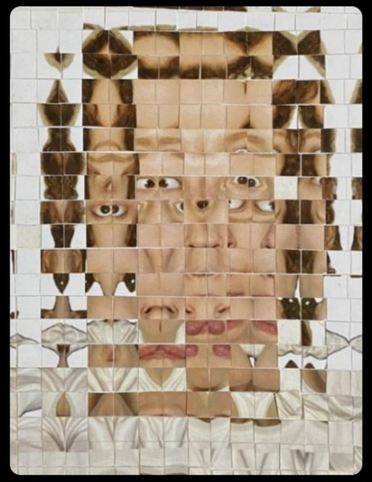
knicks championship



hosted by chris robinson

conceptual

ideas surfaced from pulses in deep research.

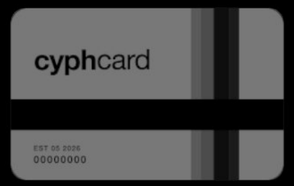


is the soul actually cartesian?



hosted by iain mcgilchrist

user journey









03

irl

close the laptop and enter our world of IRL cyphs: lectures, office hours, supper clubs, & debates. the research from the room is archived in our partner libraries.

our last cyph...





in the room

GUGGENHEIM · OpenAI · GQ · ESSENCE · Google · STUDIO MUSEUM IN HARLEM · HBO · SQUARESPACE DEPT · CODE AND THEORY · RÉSONNER · ISE-DA · NYC Public Schools · SUPERPOSITION · THE ROOT

10+ residential libraries in nyc where cyph members can check out books.

user journey







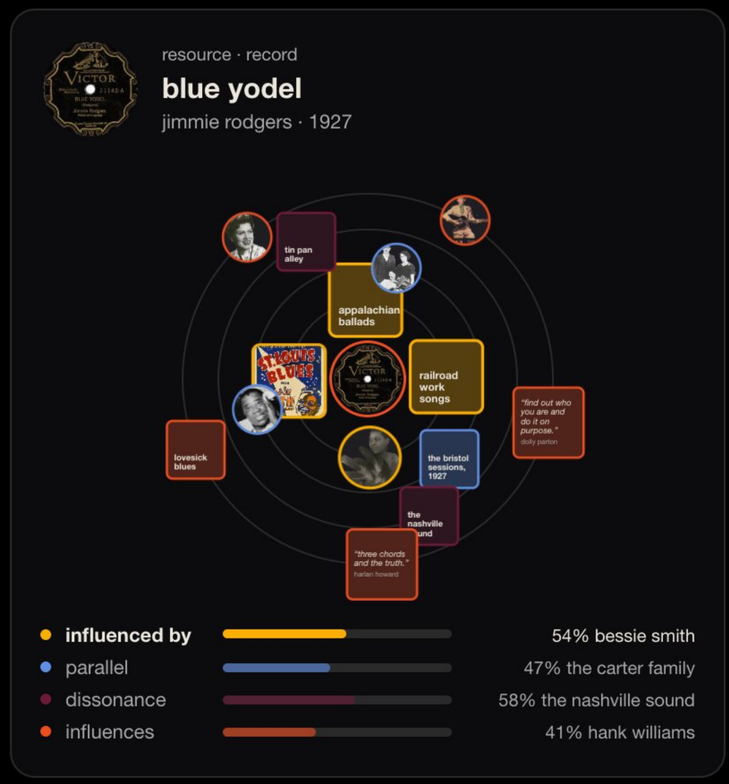


04

how it all maps together

everything on cyph has its own dna. map the influence, and intersections of your ideas over time with the cyphcard.





what real people have said.

"people are yearning to break the shackles and speak their truth."

"it encourages individuality...there's no need for an echo chamber."

"i like that it's centered around topics and things that matter rather than a sea of content."

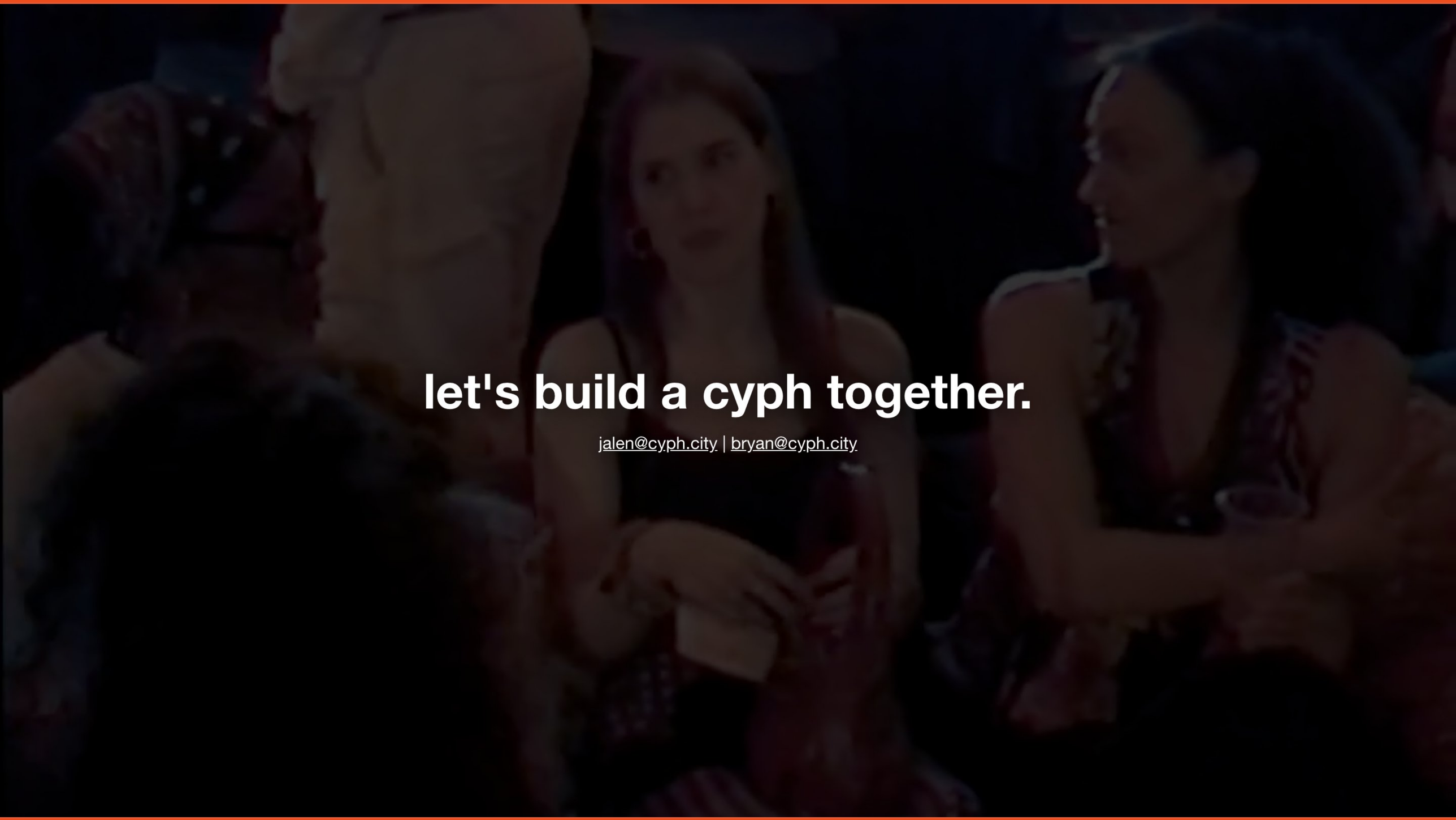
"i love cyph because I can find actual scholars whom i would want to talk with."

"humanity needs a platform that tells them to go outside."

"the internet was built to enable resource sharing and open communication, not to suppress them."

"the world needs an ed-tech platform built by someone who knows how to resonate with culture."

"this feels like a breath of fresh air. online today is extremely gimmicky."



let's build a cyph together.

jalen@cyph.city | bryan@cyph.city